

Senate President Hun Sen addressed calls for Cambodia to retaliate after Thai soldiers shot Cambodian civilians in Prey Chan village, killing one and injuring three.

Speaking at the 33rd Congress of Buddhist Monks in Phnom Penh, Mr Hun Sen cautioned that returning fire would likely cause more casualties on both sides and further jeopardize the ceasefire and the Kuala Lumpur Peace Agreement.

He said:

“The incident in Prey Chan village—they want us to open fire immediately. Now, if we open fire immediately, what will be the outcome? Please answer. They are inciting us to open fire, from one incident to another. They even shoot rubber bullets at us. They shoot almost every night. But the government has advised us not to respond.”

“Others say that they shot and killed people, and we have kept quiet. But let me ask you again: if we open fire, will only one person die and three people be injured? It could be more than that. Thai people could also die. And we could also die in Sisophon. Let’s speak clearly about that. We are not afraid of fighting, but we are asking what the outcome of fighting will be. It would destroy the ceasefire agreement and the peace declaration. Others, you can speak outside. May I ask, do you condemn those who shot and wounded Cambodian people?”